



RELOCATION GUIDE

Bay of Plenty

Te Moana-a-Toi

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Bay of Plenty.

Beaches on your doorstep. A city with room to grow.

Nau mai, haere mai ki Te Moana-a-Toi. A long, warm curve of coast on the eastern side of the North Island, wrapped around a working harbour and one of the country's fastest-growing cities. The lifestyle is genuinely excellent, and this guide also walks you through the practical side – housing especially – so you can plan the move with confidence.

~360k

people across the region

~165k

in Tauranga, NZ's fifth-largest city

2,200+

sunshine hours a year on the coast

~80%

of New Zealand's kiwifruit grown here

IN THIS GUIDE

01 Why clinicians choose the Bay of Plenty

02 The Bay at a glance

03 Healthcare in the Bay

04 Where to live in Tauranga

05 Getting around

06 What it costs to live here

07 Sophie's insights

08 Food, markets and everyday life

09 Beaches, Mauao and the hills

10 Day trips from Tauranga

11 Growing up in the Bay

12 Local directory

13 Useful contacts

14 Your Ethicare journey

Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose the Bay of Plenty

It is a lovely place to live and a growing place to work — and, with a little planning on housing, a very rewarding move.

Cook named it the Bay of Plenty because the gardens he saw from the water were so obviously productive. Three centuries on the description still fits: this is kiwifruit and avocado country, the country's largest port sits at the harbour mouth, and the region grows faster each year than almost anywhere else in New Zealand.

Most of that growth is in Tauranga. It has a proper waterfront, a lively food scene, an ocean beach fifteen minutes away, and Mauao — the volcanic cone at the end of the sandspit — which half the city seems to walk around before work. An hour and twenty minutes east, Whakatāne has its own appeal: sunnier still, relaxed, rural and excellent value.

Clinical pay in New Zealand is set nationally. A nurse, sonographer or physiotherapist on a given step earns the same in Tauranga as in Invercargill. What changes is what the money buys — and this coastline has been popular with families and retirees for thirty years, so housing is where a little planning pays off most. People we move here say the coast makes it well worth it.

Monday to Friday

15–25 MIN COMMUTE

From most of Tauranga to work, a little longer from Pāpāmoa East at peak. Parking is easier than in any UK city this size.

After work

Long light evenings for most of the year: the Mauao base track, a swim off the ocean beach, or the waterfront. The sea is comfortable from November to April.

Saturday

The farmers' market, the surf, or a roadside stall for whatever is in season. The harbour is sheltered enough to learn to sail on.

Sunday

The Pāpāmoa Hills, the Kaimai bush tracks, or an hour to Rotorua for geothermal parks and the mountain biking people fly in for.

Summer

The best of it. The holidays bring a festive buzz to the beaches and a lively pace to the department, then life eases into a relaxed rhythm by February.

WHAT THE BAY GIVES YOU

Warmth and light

Over 2,200 hours of sunshine and mild, short winters.

A growing service

New roles, new capacity and room to build a career.

A city you can cross

Big enough to have things, small enough that a fifteen-minute commute is normal.

GOOD TO KNOW

Housing takes planning

Tauranga is in high demand, so plan ahead; the wider region offers excellent value.

Time your commute

Roads are busiest for a short spell twice a day; choose where you live and you can glide past most of it.

A car

Most clinicians here run one, and it opens up the whole coast.



Pīwakawaka (fantails) are friendly regulars in gardens and on bush tracks across the North Island.



The koru, an unfurling fern frond: in Māori art it stands for new life and new beginnings.

The Bay at a glance

Two hundred kilometres of coast facing north-east into the Pacific, a sheltered harbour behind a sandspit, and a bush-covered range at your back. The geography explains almost everything about how life here works.

Start at Waihi Beach in the north-west and follow the coast: Katikati and Ōmokoroa on the sheltered inner harbour, then Tauranga, wrapped around Tauranga Moana. At the harbour mouth stands Mauao, and beyond it an unbroken run of ocean beach through Mount Maunganui and Pāpāmoa – twenty-odd kilometres of sand in one line.

Inland, Te Puke and the Western Bay are orchard country, kiwifruit under shelter belts. Behind it the Kaimai and Mamaku ranges rise into bush, and beyond them the volcanic plateau. East of Tauranga the coast grows wilder and more peaceful with every kilometre – Maketū, Whakatāne, Ōhope, Ōpōtiki – and on a clear day you can see Whakaari out to sea, still steaming.

Summer

DEC – FEB

Around 24–27°C. Hot, sunny and lively; the coastal towns come alive between Christmas and late January.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Around 18–23°C. The best months – warm sea and relaxed beaches. Keep an eye on the forecast in February and March, when the odd ex-tropical storm passes through.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Around 13–16°C. Mild and green; damp rather than cold, and frost is uncommon on the coast.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Around 16–21°C. Breezy at first, then warming nicely. Inland and over the Kaimai it is a few degrees cooler.



A winter tip on damp

Winters are mild, so the thing to manage is humidity. Newer homes handle it well; with an older house, ask about insulation, ventilation, extractor fans, a heat pump and the Healthy Homes compliance statement before you sign.

THE CONE AT THE HARBOUR MOUTH

Mauao

A maunga of deep significance to Tauranga Moana. Call it by its name rather than “the mountain”.

MOUNT MAUNGANUI

The Mount

The suburb, the beach and the cone, all at once. You will pick up the shorthand within a week.

HARBOUR AND IWI

Tauranga Moana

The harbour, and the name used for the three iwi of this area.

RANGE AND ROAD

The Kaimai

The range between here and Hamilton, and the road over it.

WHAKATĀNE TO ŌPŌTIKI

Eastern bay

A world of its own — relaxed, rural and rich in Māori culture.

SEAFOOD

Kai moana

A treasured tradition with its own rules — locals are happy to show you how it is done.



The Coromandel Peninsula, the Bay of Plenty's neighbour to the north: the coast track towards Cathedral Cove.

Healthcare in the Bay

Two public hospitals, a large community and primary care network, and a population growing faster than almost any other. For a clinician that means breadth, variety and real room to grow.

The larger site is the base hospital in Tauranga, carrying the region's acute, surgical, medical, maternity, oncology and diagnostic load. Eighty minutes east, a smaller hospital in Whakatāne serves the eastern bay with a more rural-facing scope and a genuinely broad generalist caseload.

Around them sit community and outpatient services, primary care, iwi and Māori health providers, aged residential care and district nursing, spread across a region that takes two hours to drive end to end. Complex work – neurosurgery, cardiothoracic surgery, major trauma, paediatric intensive care – is referred over the Kaimai to Hamilton, about an hour and forty minutes away.

2

public hospital sites

Tauranga and Whakatāne,
eighty minutes apart

~1 hr 40

**to the tertiary referral
centre**

over the Kaimai in Hamilton

Dec–Jan

the summer peak

well planned for

What the growth means for you

- ✓ Real career runway: an expanding service keeps creating new roles and progression.
- ✓ An older population: caseloads weighted towards age-related medicine, orthopaedics, oncology and chronic disease.
- ✓ Dynamic, growing departments: steady growth keeps opening new roles and new services.
- ✓ Broad generalist scope, especially at the smaller eastern hospital covering a large rural area.
- ✓ Meaningful equity work: in the eastern bay you can make a real difference to Māori health and to the communities that need it most.

Te ao Māori is woven through healthcare here. Ngāi Te Rangī, Ngāti Ranginui and Ngāti Pūkenga in Tauranga Moana, Ngāti Awa around Whakatāne, and Te Whānau-ā-Apanui and Whakatōhea further east are all active

in health delivery. Expect karakia at the start of meetings, te reo on the ward and whānau in the room. You can arrive knowing very little te reo; a genuine willingness to learn is warmly welcomed.



Regional practice means knowing your patients and walking alongside them.



A clinician heading in for a shift.

What to ask at interview

- ☐ Which site, and is there any cross-site working? The two sites are eighty minutes apart, in two very different places to live.
- ☐ What is the on-call or rostered-hours pattern, and how is it paid under the relevant collective agreement?
- ☐ What gets referred to Hamilton in my specialty, and how much of that pathway do I stay involved in?
- ☐ What supervision, orientation and cultural induction is there for clinicians new to New Zealand?
- ☐ How does the service plan for the December-to-January peak?

Where to live in Tauranga

Where you live here shapes three things: how easy your commute is, which school your children can attend, and how far your salary stretches.

THE HARBOUR SIDE

The commute is the prize

Most streets sit ten to fifteen minutes from the base hospital, a direct run to work.

Established everything

Mature trees, settled schools, shops that have been there thirty years.

Calmer water

Sheltered harbour edges — better for small children and kayaks than boards.

THE BEACH SIDE

The lifestyle is the prize

Ocean at the end of the street — the reason many people move here.

Newer, warmer houses

Modern builds and more floor for the money the further east you go.

Time the bridge

Most commuters cross at the same hour, so drive your route at 8am before you sign.



Mount Maunganui — ocean beach on one side, harbour on the other.

~10 MIN · APARTMENTS & TOWNHOUSES

Tauranga central

Walking distance to the CBD, the harbourside and the growing café and arts scene.

SHORT COMMUTE · HARBOUR SIDE

Ōtūmoetai & Matua

Established, leafy, family-oriented, with well-regarded schools. Popular, so start looking early.

WEST · NEWER FAMILY HOUSING

Bethlehem

Good schools and easy access into town. Popular with clinicians relocating with children.

SOUTHERN EDGE · NEW BUILDS

Pyes Pā & Tauriko

Modern warm houses, more space for the money, and a straightforward run to the hospital.

15–25 MIN · OVER THE BRIDGE

Mount Maunganui

The most sought-after address in the region. Lively in summer and genuinely lovely – be ready to move quickly when the right place comes up.

25–35 MIN · MORE AT PEAK

Pāpāmoa

Kilometres of newer family housing behind a very long beach. The most common landing spot for families.

25–40 MIN · WESTERN BAY

Ōmokoroa & Katikati

Inner-harbour living and orchard-town pace. More house for the money, with a scenic drive in.

EASTERN BAY · ITS OWN HOSPITAL

Whakatāne & Ōhope

Sunny riverside town and one of the country's favourite swimming beaches. A lovely choice in its own right rather than a suburb.

Three things to check before you sign

- ☐ The commute at the hour you would actually drive it – 7.30am on a weekday, not eleven on a Sunday.
- ☐ The school zone at the exact address. Popular state schools are zoned, so confirm the exact street.
- ☐ Insulation, ventilation and the Healthy Homes record. A dry, well-ventilated home is the key to a comfortable winter.

Most clinicians we move here rent for six to twelve months before buying, and it is the right call. It lets you learn the traffic, the schools and which beach you actually use before committing to a view.

Getting around

Tauranga is easy to get around for most of the day. It has grown quickly, so there are a couple of busy windows at peak – worth knowing when you choose where to live.

The city is built around a harbour, so it is long and thin and the water has to be crossed. Almost everything funnels through a handful of routes, and the city has grown quickly around them. For about ninety minutes twice a day the main routes are busy, then they clear completely. On shifts, you will barely notice it.

Four routes worth timing

- ✓ The harbour bridge, linking the city and Mount Maunganui – busiest at both ends of the day.
- ✓ The Pāpāmoa corridor – worth test-driving at peak before you choose a street.
- ✓ Hairini and the Welcome Bay approach, particularly the morning run in.
- ✓ State highway roadworks north of the city, which will speed things up when finished.

FROM TAURANGA TO	TYPICAL DRIVE (OFF-PEAK)
Mount Maunganui	10–20 min
Pāpāmoa East	25–40 min
Te Puke	30 min
Katikati	40 min
Rotorua	1 hr
Whakatāne	1 hr 20
Hamilton	1 hr 40
Auckland	2 hr 30 – 3 hr

Buses run across Tauranga, out to the Mount and Pāpāmoa, and around Whakatāne and Rotorua, paid for with a Bee Card that also works in the Waikato. Fares are low and the network is handy on the main routes; most households also run a car.

Cycling is genuinely good: flat, sealed coastal and harbourside paths, and a climate that makes it a pleasure most of the year. An e-bike is a common purchase. Tauranga Airport, ten minutes from the city, flies domestically; Auckland is your international airport.



Tongariro National Park, south of Taupō: a long but easy drive from the Bay for a weekend in the mountains.



Pauanui on the Coromandel, an easy summer road trip north up the coast.



Green hill country in the Waikato, on the road west towards Hamilton.

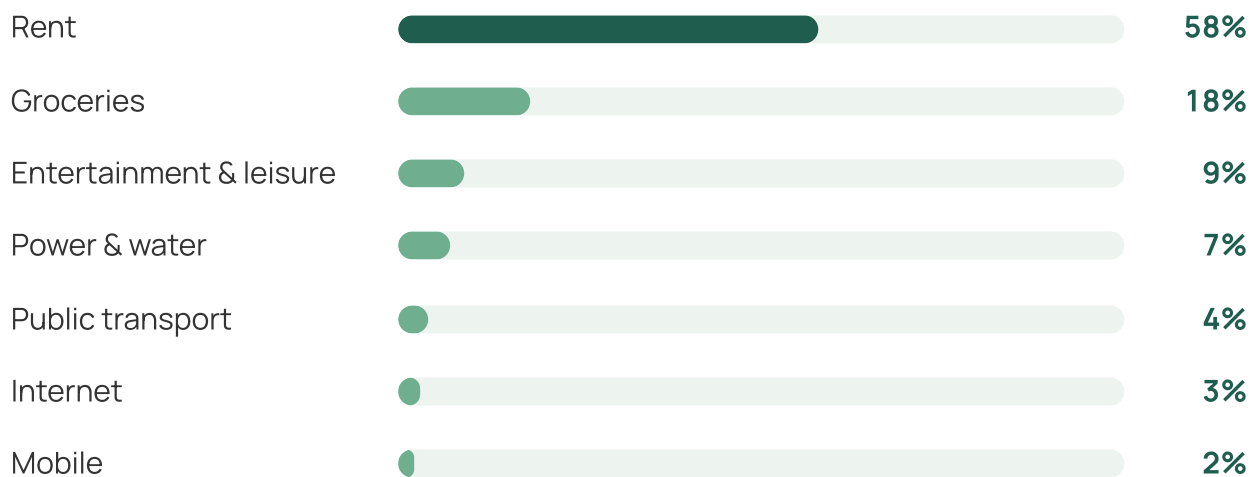
What it costs to live here

Housing is the part of a Bay move that rewards the most planning. We no longer print prices — they go stale — but the shape of a month, and what is worth budgeting for, does not change.

Three decades of people choosing this coastline — retirees, families leaving the big cities, investors following the growth — have made Tauranga one of New Zealand’s most sought-after cities, with house prices and rents close to Auckland levels. Knowing that early lets you plan well.

And the region reaches well beyond Tauranga. Move west to Katikati or Ōmokoroa, inland to Te Puke, or east to Whakatāne and Ōhope, and the numbers relax substantially — in the eastern bay, wonderfully so.

Where a month goes



proportions, not amounts — one person on a mid-range budget

AREA	RELATIVE COST	GOOD TO KNOW
Mount Maunganui & central Tauranga	Top of the regional range	Popular — be ready to move quickly
Pāpāmoa & the coastal strip	A step below the Mount	Allow a little longer at peak
Bethlehem, Ōtūmoetai, Pyes Pā	Mid-range	Good schools, sensible commutes
Katikati, Ōmokoroa, Te Puke	Great value	Around forty minutes from town

AREA	RELATIVE COST	GOOD TO KNOW
Whakatāne & Ōhope	Best value by a clear margin	A separate town with its own hospital
Ōpōtiki & Kawerau	The best value of all	Close-knit rural communities

Costs worth budgeting for

- ✓ A car, probably two – purchase, insurance, registration, warrant of fitness and fuel.
- ✓ Summer timing: holiday rentals are in high demand, so house-hunting outside January is easier and better value.
- ✓ Winter power: a newer, well-ventilated home is cheaper to keep warm and dry, so it is worth choosing carefully.
- ✓ Getting home: long-haul flights go via Auckland, so add the domestic leg or the drive.

“

**On a clinical salary you will live well here and rent comfortably.
Most people rent first and buy once they know the area
– often looking west or east, where the numbers relax.**



Seasonal produce at a weekend market: eating well costs less when you buy what is in season.



Green-lipped mussels, a New Zealand favourite and an affordable treat.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about the Bay of Plenty

The Bay is the region people ask me for by name, and I understand why – the coast sells itself. I always start with the housing conversation, because a little planning there makes everything else about the move easier.

Here is what surprises people: they come for the beach and stay for the work. A service growing this fast gives you room to build something, and the eastern bay in particular is where clinicians tell me they have done the most meaningful work of their careers.

Plan the budget early, rent for a year, and drive your commute at rush hour before you sign anything. Do that, and the rest of the move tends to look after itself.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Time outdoors together is a big part of why families make the move.



New Zealand bush is never far away, and the walks are made for small legs.

Food, markets and everyday life

You will eat well, seasonally, and much closer to the source than you are probably used to.

Around eighty per cent of New Zealand's kiwifruit comes out of this region, most of it within half an hour of Te Puke — plus avocados, citrus, feijoas and berries. The practical consequence is roadside stalls: unstaffed boxes at the end of orchard driveways with an honesty tin. The farmers' markets — Tauranga on Saturday, the Mount on Sunday — are genuinely good and not tourist-facing.

Then there is the sea: snapper, kahawai and trevally, mussels and pipi on the rocks, and a strong culture of gathering kai moana. The best food concentration is a strip of cafés, bakeries and breweries a block from the ocean beach at the Mount. Supermarket prices follow the national pattern; the markets and roadside stalls are where the Bay's best value and flavour are.



Being so close to the beach is probably the biggest change — we can finish work and go for a walk along the beach or have dinner outside. I still really miss Marks & Spencer and Waitrose!

EMMA, RADIATION THERAPIST — MOVED FROM HARROGATE TO TAURANGA WITH HER FAMILY

Good to know

- ✓ Shops keep regular hours — most retail winds down by 5.30 or 6pm, and Sundays are relaxed.
- ✓ Everyday shopping is all close by; for a big shopping day, Hamilton and Auckland make an easy trip, and online covers the rest.
- ✓ Big touring shows and exhibitions make a fun weekend away in Auckland, Hamilton or Wellington.
- ✓ Tauranga has Asian and Indian grocers; very specific imports can be ordered online or picked up on an Auckland trip.

Social life is largely outdoors and informal: barbecues, beach evenings, the park. Club rugby, netball, surf lifesaving, touch, sailing and running groups are the social glue — joining one is the fastest way to know people. And because the Bay has absorbed more internal migration than almost anywhere, your neighbours will mostly be new too.

Beaches, Mauao and the hills

The reason people move here. Most of it is free, and most of it is fifteen minutes from your front door.



From the flanks of Mauao, looking along the ocean beach.

The base track around Mauao is a flat, sealed loop of about three and a half kilometres at the water's edge, busy with walkers and runners all day. The summit track climbs steeply for around forty minutes to ocean on one side and harbour on the other. It is a maunga of real significance to Tauranga Moana — you are warmly welcome; walk it with respect.

~15 min

the ocean beach
& Mauao

~30 min

the Kaimai Range

~1 hr

Rotorua's
geothermal
country

~1 hr 20

Ōhope and the
eastern bay

MOUNT TO PĀPĀMOA

The ocean beach

Patrolled in summer, surfable most of the year, and long enough that you can always find space.

SHELTERED WATER

The harbour

Sailing, kayaking and paddleboarding. Boat ownership is common and more affordable than you'd expect.

AN HOUR, START TO FINISH

The Pāpāmoa Hills

A short, steep climb to a pā site and a view over the whole bay.

HALF AN HOUR

The Kaimai Range

Bush tracks, waterfalls and swing bridges, and cool green shade in midsummer.

~20 MIN

McLaren Falls Park

Lakes, waterfalls, big trees and picnic lawns on the city's edge. A family favourite.

AT THE FOOT OF MAUAO

Mount Hot Pools

Warm saltwater pools by the beach — the classic winter-evening treat.

What people actually do at the weekend

- ✓ Saturday farmers' market in Tauranga, Sunday at the Mount — then coffee and a swim.
- ✓ Surf lifesaving nippers, club rugby, netball, touch and junior football for the kids.
- ✓ Mountain biking or a forest walk in Rotorua, an hour away.
- ✓ Walk or run the Mauao base track, or climb to the summit for sunrise.
- ✓ Paddleboarding and kayaking on the sheltered harbour, or fishing off the wharf.
- ✓ Summer evenings at the beach with a barbecue — the most Bay of Plenty thing there is.



Geothermal country, an hour inland.



A historic swing bridge in the Waioeka Gorge, inland from Ōpōtiki.



Riroriro, the grey warbler — a common voice in the bush.

i

A note on Whakaari

On a clear day you can see Whakaari | White Island steaming offshore. The 2019 eruption there killed twenty-two people and is deeply felt in this region, particularly in Whakatāne, where the tours departed. There are no landing tours; it is spoken about with care.

Day trips from Tauranga

Tauranga sits in the middle of some of the North Island's best-known country. Geothermal Rotorua, the Coromandel's beaches, Lake Taupō and the volcanic mountains are all within a day trip or an easy weekend.

Inland, Rotorua is an hour away: geysers and hot pools, the Redwoods forest, lakes and world-class mountain biking. Over the Kaimai, Matamata has the Hobbiton movie set, and Hamilton — about an hour and a half — adds a bigger city, the Hamilton Gardens and the region's tertiary hospital.

North, the coast runs on to Waihi Beach and the Coromandel Peninsula. South, Lake Taupō and Tongariro National Park are an easy weekend, with skiing on Mt Ruapehu in winter. Auckland, for concerts, big shopping trips and the international airport, is two and a half to three hours up the road.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Mount Maunganui ocean beach	about 15 min	The nearest surf and swimming beach — patrolled in summer
Pilot Bay, the Mount	about 15 min	Calm harbour-side swimming for small children
Ski fields: Whakapapa & Tūroa, Mt Ruapehu	~3–3.5 hrs	Ruapehu's ski fields make a great winter weekend
Hamilton	~1.5 hrs	The nearest larger city and the tertiary hospital
Auckland	~2.5–3 hrs	New Zealand's biggest city: concerts, shopping, events
Auckland Airport	~2.5–3 hrs	The international airport; Tauranga Airport (~10 min) is domestic
Rotorua	about 1 hr	Geothermal parks, Redwoods forest, lakes, mountain biking
Hobbiton, Matamata	about 1 hr	The movie-set tour, and a pretty farming town
Whakatāne & Ōhope	~1 hr 20	A favourite family swimming beach and the eastern bay

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Lake Taupō	~2 hrs	The country's largest lake, and the road to the mountains
~1 HR Rotorua Geysers, hot pools, Māori cultural experiences, the Redwoods and some of the best mountain biking in the world.		~1 HR · MATAMATA Hobbiton The film set from The Lord of the Rings, in rolling Waikato farmland. A favourite with visiting family.
~45–50 MIN Waihī Beach & Karangahake Gorge A long, relaxed surf beach, then an old gold-mining gorge with tunnels, rail trail and river walks.		~1 HR 20 Ōhope & Whakatāne A sunny riverside town and a long, safe swimming beach — an easy family weekend.
~2.5 HRS The Coromandel Hahei, Cathedral Cove and Hot Water Beach: white sand, clear water and bush-backed bays.		~2–3 HRS Taupō & Tongariro The great lake, the Tongariro Alpine Crossing and, in winter, the ski fields on Mt Ruapehu.



Hobbiton, the film set near Matamata in the Waikato – about an hour from Tauranga.



Hahei on the Coromandel Peninsula, about two and a half hours north.



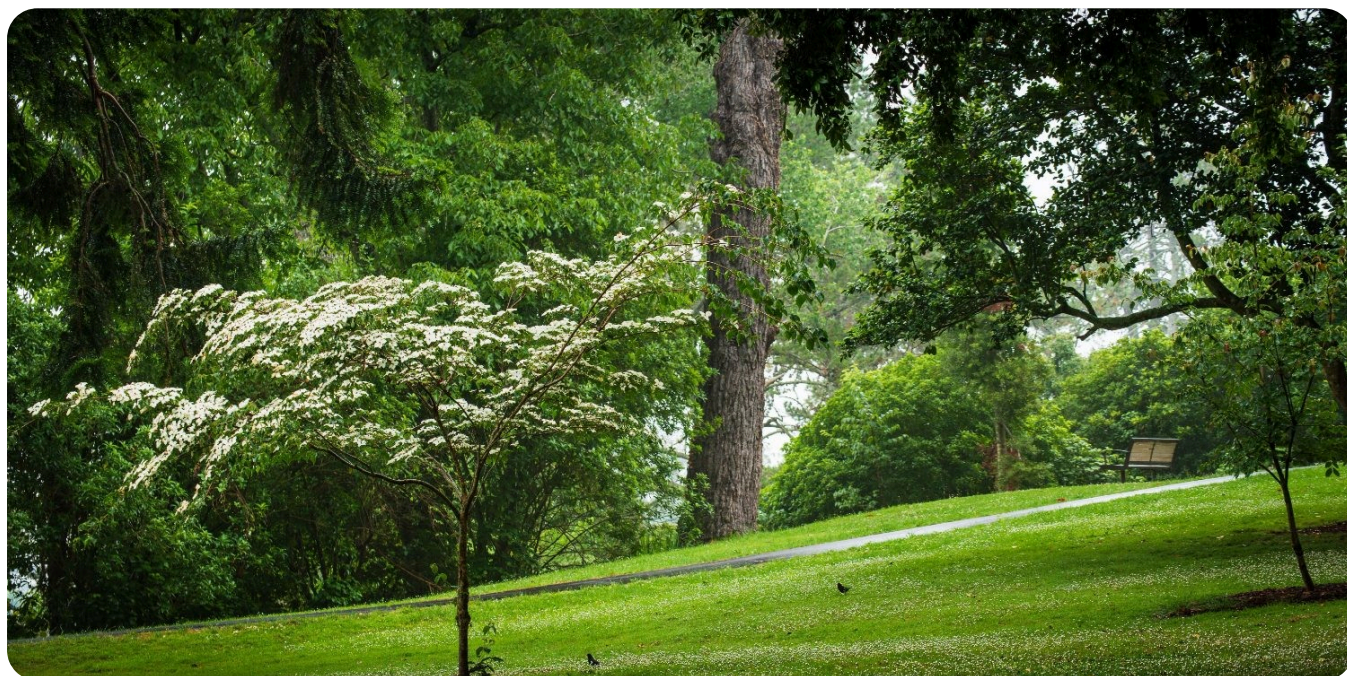
A family day at Whakapapa on Mt Ruapehu – the nearest ski fields, about three hours away.

Growing up in the Bay

Space, safety, warmth, beaches, sport and a full range of schooling — and, unusually for a regional city, plenty for teenagers too.

Childhood here is outdoors. The beach is part of the week rather than a holiday, parks and playgrounds are everywhere, and the Baywave aquatic centre and the libraries anchor the wet days. Surf lifesaving nippers, sailing, rugby, netball and football clubs are how children — and their parents — make friends.

The pace suits families: short commutes leave time for the school run and after-school sport, and the city is big enough that teenagers have things to do. It is an unusually easy place to be new, because so many of your neighbours moved here too.



Yatton Park — mature parkland inside the city.

Schools follow the national pattern: free state schools, state-integrated schools (often with a church character) and a few independent schools. Popular state schools run enrolment zones, so the exact address decides eligibility. Long-established secondary options include Tauranga Boys' College, Tauranga Girls' College and Mount Maunganui College; Bethlehem, Ōtūmoetai and Pāpāmoa are where most relocating families land.

For under-fives there are kindergartens, daycares and playcentres across the city, and 20 hours of free early childhood education for three- to five-year-olds. Tertiary study is local too: the University of Waikato has a campus in central Tauranga, and Toi Ohomai Institute of Technology teaches across the region.

Choosing a school from overseas

- ✓ Read any school's Education Review Office (ERO) report at ero.govt.nz — the independent view of how it is doing.
- ✓ Check the school's enrolment zone against the exact address before you sign a lease.
- ✓ Ask about state-integrated options if a faith-based school matters to you.
- ✓ Children usually start school on or after their fifth birthday, and must be enrolled by six.

IT SUITS YOU BEST IF...

- ✓ You are happy to rent for a while before buying — or to look west or east, where buying comes sooner.
- ✓ Your specialty fits a busy, growing base hospital, with tertiary referral to Hamilton.
- ✓ You are comfortable driving — this is a car-friendly region, with good cycle paths besides.
- ✓ You enjoy a lively summer: the coast fills up in January and settles by February.
- ✓ Comparing coasts? Hawke's Bay and Northland offer similar warmth at a different price point.

“

People come to the Bay for the beach and stay for the work — and they love both.

Your Bay of Plenty address book

Tauranga has the region's largest migrant community, with a fast-growing Malayali association (ATMA), a large Filipino club, an active Indian and Sikh community and a long-running multicultural council at The Historic Village. Rotorua and Whakatāne are smaller but have their own multicultural council and English classes, and Rotorua has a gurdwara and a Hindu heritage centre.

COUNCILS

Tauranga City Council

Rates, rubbish, libraries, parks and pools in Tauranga and the Mount

tauranga.govt.nz

Western Bay of Plenty District Council

Katikati, Te Puke, Ōmokoroa and the rural west

westernbay.govt.nz

Whakatāne District Council

Whakatāne, Ōhope and the eastern bay

whakatane.govt.nz

Bay of Plenty Regional Council

Regional council: the Baybus network, environment and civil defence

boprc.govt.nz

GETTING AROUND

Baybus

Bus timetables and fares for Tauranga and the wider region

baybus.co.nz

SETTLING IN & EXPLORING

New Zealand Newcomers Network

Local newcomers' groups, including Tauranga

newcomers.co.nz

Department of Conservation

Tracks and campsites in the Kaimai Range and beyond

doc.govt.nz

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Association of Tauranga Malayalee Aotearoa (ATMA)

Tauranga's Kerala/Malayali association: Onam, Vishu, Christmas events and family gatherings

atma.org.nz

Multicultural Tauranga (Tauranga Regional Multicultural Council)

Settlement help, free walk-in English conversation, newcomers' networking mornings, driving lessons, JP service and events

trmc.co.nz

Bay of Plenty Interpreting Service (BOPIS)

Interpreting and document translation, run by Multicultural Tauranga

trmc.co.nz/interpreting-translation.html

Club Filipino Tauranga

Tauranga's main Filipino community club, with a large and active Facebook group

Indian Community of Tauranga / Sanatan Dharam Trust

Indian community trust behind Tauranga's Hindu temple; Friday evening gatherings and the main Hindu festivals

Rotorua Multicultural Council

Rotorua's migrant settlement group: cultural events, conversational English and friendship

facebook.com/RotoruaMulticulturalCouncil

SHAMA Ethnic Women's Trust

Culturally aware support for migrant and ethnic women and their families

shama.org.nz

AvaNiu Pasifika

Pacific community organisation in Tauranga: wellbeing, events and opportunities

avaniu.co.nz

Bay of Plenty Chinese Business & Commerce Association

Network for Chinese-speaking business owners and newcomers in the Bay

English Language Partners Tauranga

Free and low-cost English classes, home tutoring, workplace English and IELTS prep; Greerton and Pāpāmoa

07 571 4181

englishlanguage.org.nz/centres/tauranga

English Language Partners Rotorua

English classes and home tutoring in Rotorua, with classrooms in Whakatāne too

07 350 2395

englishlanguage.org.nz/centres/rotorua

Citizens Advice Bureau – Migrant Connect

Free, confidential advice on anything from tenancy to visas; Tauranga and Rotorua bureaux run sessions for new migrants

cab.org.nz/find-a-cab/migrant-connect

Tauranga City Council – Welcoming Communities

Council's newcomer page listing local settlement services

tauranga.govt.nz/community/community-services/welcoming-communities

Western Bay of Plenty – Cultural diversity

Newcomer links for Te Puke, Katikati and the rural Western Bay

westernbay.govt.nz/community/cultural-diversity

Rotorua Lakes Council – Welcoming Communities

Rotorua's newcomer page, settlement support list and services map

rotorualakescouncil.nz/community/welcoming-communities

Volunteering Bay of Plenty

Find volunteer roles, which is a quick way to meet people and get local experience

volbop.org.nz

FACEBOOK & ONLINE GROUPS

ATMA – Tauranga Malayalee

Malayali community page: event notices, Onam tickets and welcome contacts

facebook.com/taurangamalayalee

Club Filipino Tauranga (Facebook group)

Thousands of members; housing, jobs, events and advice for Filipino families

Tauranga Regional Multicultural Council

Notices for English classes, newcomers' mornings and cultural events

facebook.com/TaurangaRegionalMulticulturalCouncil

English Language Partners Bay of Plenty

Class terms, conversation groups and enrolment notices

facebook.com/EnglishLanguagePartnersBayofPlenty

Sanatan Dharam Trust

Tauranga Hindu temple page: festival dates and Friday prayers

facebook.com/SanatanDharamTrust

PLACES OF WORSHIP

Catholic Parish of St Thomas Aquinas, Tauranga Moana

Central Tauranga Catholic parish: St Mary Immaculate (114 Elizabeth St), plus Bethlehem and Te Puna

taurangamoanacatholic.nz

Catholic Parish of All Saints by the Sea

Catholic churches at Mount Maunganui, Pāpāmoa, Te Puke and Maketū

allsaintsbythesea.nz

St Mary of the Cross MacKillop Parish, Rotorua

Rotorua Catholic parish: St Mary's, 40–44 Seddon St, and St Michael's, Ōhinemutu

rotorua.cdh.nz

St Peter Chanel Catholic Parish, Whakatāne

Whakatāne Catholic church, 125 King St

cdh.org.nz/whakatane

Holy Trinity Anglican Church, Tauranga

Central Tauranga Anglican parish, 215 Devonport Rd

waiapuanglicans.org.nz/communities

St Luke's Anglican Church, Rotorua

Central Rotorua Anglican church, corner Amohia and Pukuatua Sts

waiapuanglicans.org.nz/communities

Whakatāne Anglican Methodist Parish

Combined Anglican and Methodist congregation in Whakatāne

wham.org.nz

City Church Tauranga

Large Pentecostal (Assemblies of God) church in Otūmoetai

citychurch.nz

Rotorua Christian Life Centre

Pentecostal (Assemblies of God) church in Mangakāhiki, Rotorua

rotoruaclc.org.nz

Liberty Life Church, Whakatāne

Pentecostal church, 65 Wairaka Rd

libertytrust.org.nz

Tauranga Mosque (Tauranga Muslim Association)

The Bay's mosque and Muslim community, 85 Eighteenth Ave, Tauranga South; ask here about halal meat

register.charities.govt.nz/Charity/CC44229

Sanatan Dharam Mandir

Tauranga's Hindu temple, 108 Whiore Ave, Tauriko; Friday evening prayers and festivals

facebook.com/SanatanDharamTrust

Hindu Heritage Centre Rotorua

Hindu Council centre at 225 Malfroy Rd: Hindi classes, meditation, yoga and Diwali, Holi, Navratri

Gurdwara Sikh Sangat Tauranga

Gurdwara at 43 Burrows St, Tauranga South; organises the annual Sikh parade

Gurdwara Sri Kalgidhar Sahib

Second Tauranga gurdwara, 322 Cheyne Rd, Pyes Pā

Gurdwara Sri Guru Amardas Sahib Ji, Rotorua

Rotorua's gurdwara, 24 Ward Ave, Fenton Park

Bay of Plenty Buddhist Society

Theravada Buddhist temple and monks at 453 Kaitemako Rd, Welcome Bay

Waikato Jewish Association

No synagogue in the Bay; this group covers Jewish families in Waikato and the Bay of Plenty

The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints

Tauranga has its own stake, including a Tongan-language branch; find a meetinghouse here

churchofjesuschrist.org/maps/meetinghouses

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Best Buy Asian Supermarket

Asian grocer, 353 Cameron Rd, central Tauranga

Asia's Best

Asian grocer, 771 Cameron Rd, Tauranga South

Vetro Mediterranean Foods

Italian and Mediterranean deli goods, 111 Third Ave, Tauranga

vetro.co.nz

Spice World, Rotorua

Spice and specialty grocer in Rotorua

Halal and kosher meat

No dedicated halal butcher confirmed; ask Tauranga Mosque for current suppliers. No kosher shop in the Bay: order from Auckland suppliers

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

PAK'nSAVE

Lowest-price chain: Cameron Rd Tauranga, Fenton St Rotorua and King St Whakatāne

paknsave.co.nz

New World

Brookfield, Gate Pā and Mount Maunganui in Tauranga; Rotorua West End and Hillcrest; Whakatāne

newworld.co.nz

Woolworths

Several Tauranga stores (Tauranga South, Otūmoetai, Bethlehem, the Mount), plus Rotorua and Whakatāne

woolworths.co.nz

FreshChoice Te Ngae

Smaller supermarket in Ōwhata, eastern Rotorua

freshchoice.co.nz

Four Square

Neighbourhood stores in Welcome Bay, Bethlehem, Greerton, Ngongotahā and elsewhere

foursquare.co.nz

Tauranga Farmers' Market

Saturdays 7:45am–noon at Tauranga Primary School; local produce straight from growers

taurangafarmersmarket.co.nz

SCHOOLS, UNIFORMS & FAMILIES

Education Counts – find a school

Search schools and check enrolment zones by address

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

NZ Uniforms

School uniform stockist with stores in Tauranga, Rotorua and Whakatāne; also check your school's own uniform shop and PTA second-hand sales

nzuniforms.com

Plunket

Free Well Child checks and parenting support for under-5s; register when you arrive

plunket.org.nz

Playcentre

Parent-led early childhood centres; a good way for parents to meet people

playcentre.org.nz

Tauranga City Libraries

Free membership, children's sessions and computers across the city

library.tauranga.govt.nz

Rotorua Library

Central library and children's programmes; partner in the Welcoming Communities plan

rotorualakescouncil.nz

Whakatāne District Libraries

Libraries in Whakatāne, Ōhope, Edgecumbe and Murupara

whakatane.govt.nz/services/library

HOUSING & AREAS

Trade Me – Tauranga rentals

The main place rentals are advertised

trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/bay-of-plenty/tauranga

Trade Me – Rotorua rentals

Rotorua rental listings

trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/bay-of-plenty/rotorua

Trade Me – Whakatāne rentals

Whakatāne rental listings

trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/bay-of-plenty/whakatane

realestate.co.nz – Tauranga

Homes for sale in Tauranga and the Mount

realestate.co.nz/residential/sale/bay-of-plenty/tauranga

realestate.co.nz – Rotorua

Homes for sale in Rotorua

realestate.co.nz/residential/sale/bay-of-plenty/rotorua

Tenancy Services – market rent

Check typical rents for a suburb and house size before you apply

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Tauranga City Council – rates

Look up the rates on a Tauranga property

tauranga.govt.nz

Rotorua Lakes Council – rates

Rates and property information for Rotorua

rotorualakescouncil.nz

Whakatāne District Council – rates search

Rates property search for Whakatāne district

whakatane.govt.nz/residents/rates/rates-property-search

Trade Me – flatmates wanted

Rooms and flatshares if you are coming ahead of your family

trademe.co.nz/a/property/flatmates-wanted

GETTING AROUND

Baybus

Regional buses (Bayhopper and Cityride) across Tauranga, Rotorua and Whakatāne; journey planner and timetables

0800 884 880 baybus.co.nz

Bee Card

Bus fare card for the Bay of Plenty, also used in the Waikato and Hawke's Bay; top up online

beecard.co.nz

Tauranga Airport

Domestic flights, ten minutes from the city; international travel goes via Auckland

tauranga.govt.nz

Rotorua Airport

Domestic flights from Rotorua

InterCity

Long-distance coaches linking Tauranga, Rotorua and Whakatāne to Auckland, Hamilton and beyond

intercity.co.nz

NZTA – driver licensing

Converting an overseas licence and finding a licensing agent

nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

AA

Licence conversions, tests and vehicle checks at AA centres

aa.co.nz

COST OF LIVING COMPARISONS

Numbeo – Tauranga

User-reported cost of living for Tauranga, comparable with your home city

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Tauranga

Numbeo – Rotorua

User-reported cost of living for Rotorua (smaller sample)

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Rotorua

Tenancy Services – market rent

Official median rents by suburb from bond data

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Stats NZ

Official figures on prices, wages and household spending

stats.govt.nz

Powerswitch

Compare power and broadband plans for your address

powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free budgeting tools for your first months

sorted.org.nz



Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in New Zealand you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time

111

Healthline

Free 24/7 health advice from a nurse, in any language

0800 611 116

Need to talk?

Free call or text a trained counsellor, 24/7

1737

National Poisons Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned

0800 764 766

PlunketLine

Free 24/7 support for parents of under-fives

0800 933 922

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Immigration New Zealand

Visas, the Green List and residence pathways

immigration.govt.nz

Immigration Advisers Authority

Check an adviser is licensed before you pay

iaa.govt.nz

Responsible authorities

The registration board for every regulated health profession

health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions

Nursing Council of New Zealand

Registration for nurses

nursingcouncil.org.nz

Medical Council of New Zealand

Registration for doctors

mcnz.org.nz

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

How public healthcare works and who is eligible

tewhatuora.govt.nz

Healthpoint

Find a GP, pharmacy, dentist or urgent care near you

healthpoint.co.nz

ACC

Accident cover for everyone in New Zealand, including visitors

acc.co.nz

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

Find a school

Every school, with its enrolment zone

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Education Review Office

Independent reports on schools and early learning

ero.govt.nz

Parents and whānau

How schooling, early childhood education and fees work

parents.education.govt.nz

MONEY, HOME & GETTING AROUND

Inland Revenue (IRD)

Your IRD number, tax and KiwiSaver
ird.govt.nz

Tenancy Services

Renting rules, bonds and market rents by area
tenancy.govt.nz

NZ Transport Agency

Converting your overseas driver licence
nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

Powerswitch

Compare power companies in your area
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free, independent budgeting tools
sorted.org.nz

MPI · pets

Bringing cats and dogs into New Zealand
mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz

SETTLING IN

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with almost any question
0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Support and connections for new migrant communities
ethniccommunities.govt.nz

Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks, campsites and Great Walks bookings
doc.govt.nz



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not licensed immigration advisers.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

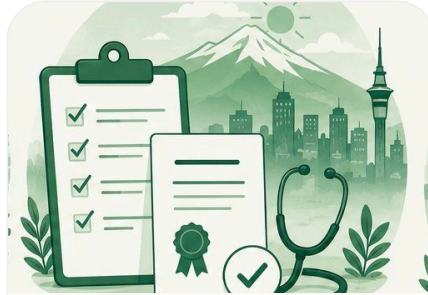
Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

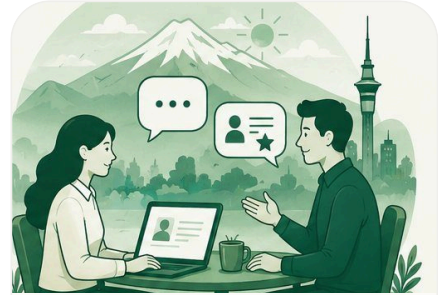
A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to New Zealand registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

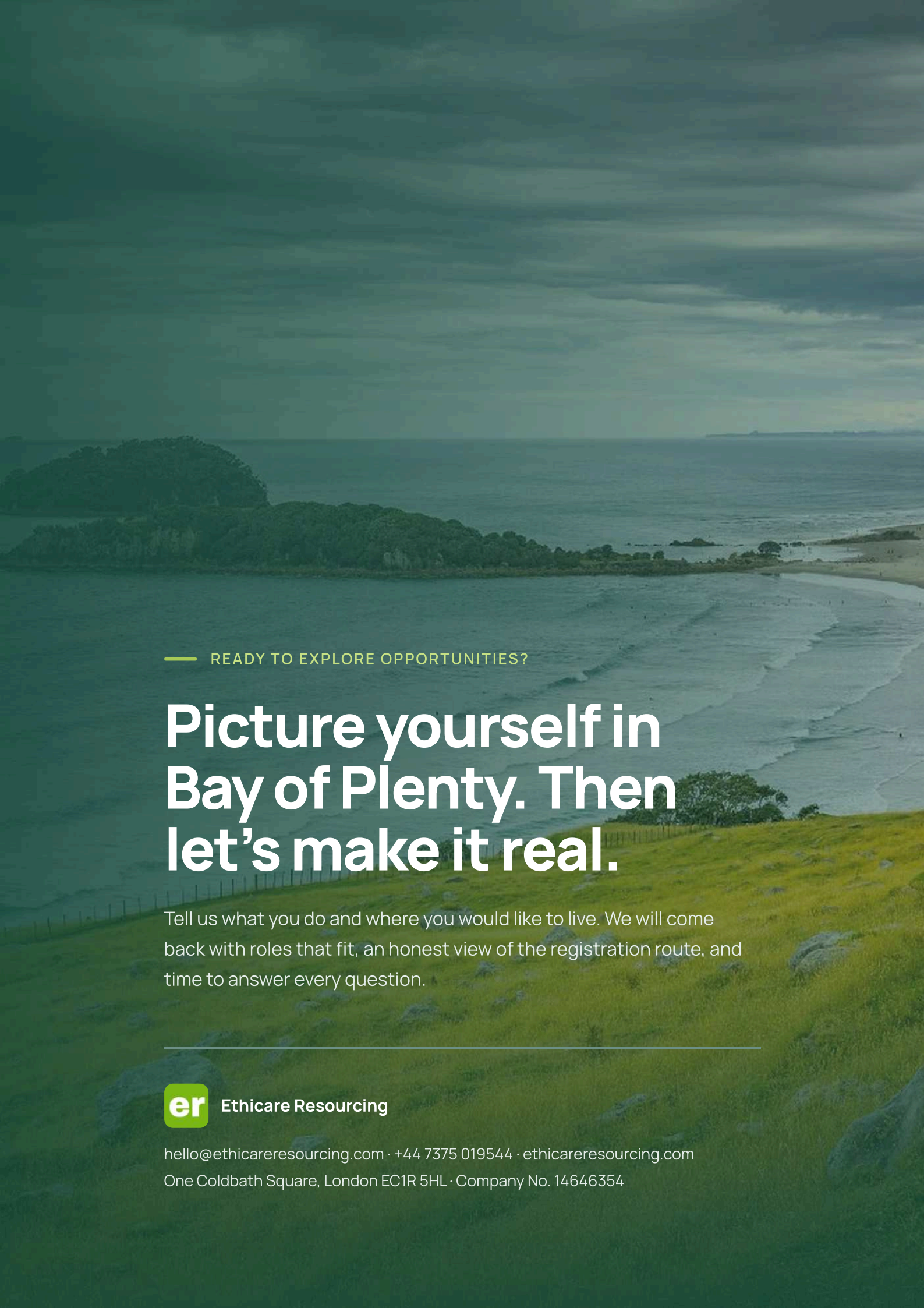
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Bay of Plenty. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, an honest view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

hello@ethicareresourcing.com · +44 7375 019544 · ethicareresourcing.com

One Coldbath Square, London EC1R 5HL · Company No. 14646354